PARAMOUNT+

THE FUTURE OF THE STREAMING BUSINESS

THE NEXT STORY STARTS HERE.

An original-content strategy for a younger audience.

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Spring 2024 academic strategy project

A CHANGE AT THE TOP.

Reports point to Bob Bakish's exit amid Skydance talks.





The bigger question:

What should Paramount+ do next?

Paramount+ needs new stories worth subscribing for.

Move away from nostalgia as the central content strategy.

ORIGINAL CONCEPTS

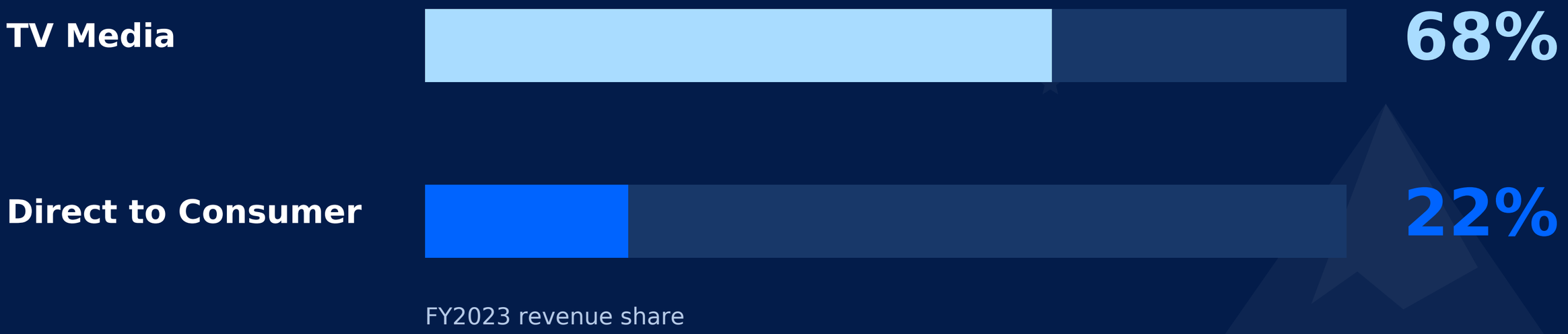
New characters, distinctive worlds, and stories audiences have not already seen.

NEW CREATIVE VOICES

Emerging writers and producers with perspectives that connect with younger viewers.

Basis: Alexandre strategic action, pp. 1-2; original team deck, pp. 4-6. Proposed strategic direction, not a reported company decision.

TV carries the business. Streaming must build its future.



The shift to streaming requires a compelling offer for the audience Paramount wants to win next.

Source: original team deck, p. 3. Segment revenue shares are approximate. Other segments and eliminations are omitted.

67.5M

Paramount+ subscribers
Q4 2023

~$1.6B

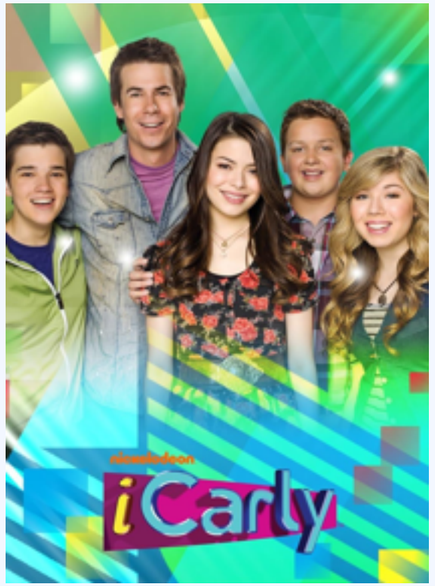
FY2023 DTC
adjusted OIBDA loss

Original content needs a clear audience and a disciplined investment case.

Sources: corporate data sheet, pp. 1-2; original team deck, p. 3. DTC includes more than Paramount+, including Pluto TV.

Revisiting a known world. Creating a new one.

PARAMOUNT+ / REBOOTS



iCarly



Frasier

Reintroduce existing characters.

NETFLIX / ORIGINAL CONCEPTS



BoJack Horseman



Stranger Things

Build interest in new characters and stories.

Examples and posters: original deck, p. 5; script, p. 2. Selected comparisons illustrate the thesis, not either platform's entire catalog.





Make the next story a reason to join.

The project points to Netflix originals as examples of distinctive storytelling that gives a platform its own identity.

Basis: Alexandre strategic action, p. 1; presentation script, p. 2. Examples support a creative benchmark, not a causal retention claim.

18–34

Proposed priority audience

Younger adults who need a compelling reason to add Paramount+ to their subscriptions.

Discover their interests

Research the themes, genres, and characters they want to see.

Include people outside the fan base

Speak with prospective subscribers and recent cancellers.

Validate concepts

Use audience response to refine new stories before production.

Audience priority: planner, p. 2. Research approach is proposed. The source materials do not prove that all younger viewers reject reboots.

New stories start with new voices.

01

Discover

Recruit emerging writers through open calls and targeted talent searches.

02

Support

Pair fresh perspectives with experienced producers and paid development.

03

Commission

Give the strongest original concepts a path from script to screen.

Basis: Alexandre strategic action, p. 2. Open calls and paid development are proposed execution details.

What makes a concept worth developing?

01 **An original premise**

A clear story hook that stands on its own.

02 **A distinctive point of view**

Characters and conflicts grounded in a fresh perspective.

03 **A defined audience**

Specific interests and viewing needs the concept serves.

04 **A reason to keep watching**

A compelling episode and season arc within an achievable budget.

Proposed commissioning criteria extending the individual memo's recommendation for fresh storytelling. No concepts have been tested.

Lead with the story.
Let creators bring viewers in.

Introduce	Creator-led clips reveal the premise and point of view.	**Qualified discovery**
Convert	Title-specific campaigns give interested viewers a direct path to watch.	**Incremental paid starts**
Build a habit	Episodes and follow-on recommendations encourage return viewing.	**Completion and retention**

Basis: original deck, p. 4; script, pp. 1-2. Campaign and measurement design are proposed.

Redirect development toward original ideas.

The first move

Reallocate an approved share of development spending to new concepts and emerging creators.

Fund in stages

Approve development first, then release production funds after creative and finance reviews.

Evaluate divestitures separately

The original project proposed selling non-core assets. Timing, proceeds, and business impact require separate analysis.

Funding controls are proposed. Planner, p. 3, suggests non-core asset sales but supplies no valuation or proceeds analysis.

From original concept to a funded slate.

MONTHS 0-2

Set the brief

Audience research and the development budget.

MONTHS 3-5

Find the stories

Creator recruitment, scripts, and concept testing.

MONTHS 6-9

Select the slate

Greenlights, production budgets, and campaign planning.

MONTHS 10-12

Review progress

Production milestones and any available launch results.

Proposed execution plan. Production may exceed 12 months. Launch and retention evaluation follow the actual release schedule.

Do new stories win new viewers and bring them back?

WIN

Incremental paid starts

Do the original titles attract subscribers beyond existing franchise audiences?

RETAIN

90-day paid retention

Do viewers keep paying and return after the title that brought them in?

ECONOMIC CHECK: COST PER RETAINED SUBSCRIBER AND BUDGET ADHERENCE

Proposed scorecard. Establish baselines and comparable cohorts before setting targets. No measured impact is claimed.

A platform for the next original story.

Invest in new concepts.
Back emerging voices.
Give younger audiences a reason to subscribe.

Recommendation synthesized from the original team project and Alexandre's individual strategic action, Spring 2024.

Paramount

Appendix

https://ir.paramount.com/static-files/dd6d3e50-c0a3-47af-acf8-29ec374dc552
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